MIL-T-43492C
20 August 1987
SUPERSEDING
MIL-T-43492B(GL)
30 March 1977

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

# TENT SECTIONS, FRAME TYPE, EXPANDABLE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

## 1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers tent sections for an expandable, frame-supported tent of wind-resistant cotton sateen (see 6.1). Minimum dimensions of the expandable tent are as follows: Length 16 feet; width 16 feet; ridge height 8 feet, 6 inches; eave height 6 feet. Also included are a cover for the 16 foot by 16 foot tent, and arch and purlin carrying covers for the tent frame sections.

1.2 Classification. Tent sections shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - End section

Type II - Intermediate section

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8340

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## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1.1 Documents. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

| | |
|---|---|
| L-P-378 | - Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin |
| L-S-125 | - Screening, Insect, Nonmetallic |
| T-T-871 | - Twine, Cotton, Wrapping |
| T-T-911 | - Twine, Fibrous, Jute |
| V-F-106 | - Fasteners, Slide, Interlocking |
| V-T-285 | - Thread, Polyester |
| TT-P-595 | - Preservative Coating, Canvas |
| CCC-C-419 | - Cloth, Duck, Cotton, Unbleached, Plied-Yarns, Army and Numbered |
| CCC-C-429 | - Cloth, Osnaburg, Cotton |
| CCC-C-467 | - Cloth, Burlap, Jute (or Kenaf) |
| CCC-D-950 | - Dyeing and Aftertreating Processes for Cotton Cloths |
| DDD-L-20 | - Label: for Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage, (General Use) |
| PPP-B-601 | - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood |

MILITARY

| | |
|---|---|
| MIL-C-496 | - Clips, End, Strap |
| MIL-W-530 | - Webbing, Textile, Cotton, General Purpose, Natural or in Colors |
| MIL-H-639 | - Hooks (for Belts, Straps, and Equipage Items) |
| MIL-R-1670 | - Rope, Tent-Lay |
| MIL-L-1709 | - Lines, Tent |
| MIL-S-1734 | - Slips, Tent Line |
| MIL-R-2327 | - Rings, Connecting, Round |
| MIL-C-2399 | - Cement, Liquid, Tent Patching |
| MIL-W-4088 | - Webbing, Textile, Woven Nylon |
| MIL-F-10884 | - Fasteners, Snap |
| MIL-L-11075 | - Loops, Strap Fastener |
| MIL-C-12095 | - Cloth, Wind-Resistant Sateen, Cotton; Fire and Water Resistant |



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| | |
|---|---|
| MIL-G-16491 | - Grommet, Metallic |
| MIL-F-21840 | - Fastener Tapes, Hook and Pile, Synthetic |
| MIL-T-40625 | - Tubing, Bias Sewn (Burlap or Osnaburg), Cloth |
| MIL-S-43002 | - Shield, Stovepipe, Tent, Nonmetallic |
| MIL-C-43256 | - Cord, Polyester, Solid Braid |
| MIL-T-43566 | - Tape, Textile, Cotton or Polyester, General Purpose, Natural or in Colors |
| MIL-C-43627 | - Cloth, Duck, Cotton, Plied Yarns, Fire, Water, Weather and Mildew Resistant Treated, Lightdry Finish |
| MIL-W-44049 | - Webbing, Textile and Tape, Textile, Polypropylene, General Purpose, Natural or in Colors |

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

| | |
|---|---|
| FED-STD-751 | - Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings |

MILITARY

| | |
|---|---|
| MIL-STD-105 | - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes |
| MIL-STD-129 | - Marking for Shipment and Storage |
| MS 70101 | - Adapter, Reversible, Quick Fit, 500 lb; 1-3/4 Inch |

2.1.2 Other Government documents. The following other Government documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

Department of the Army Field Manual FM 10-16 -
General Repair of Tents, Canvas and Webbing

DRAWINGS

U.S. ARMY NATICK RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT, AND ENGINEERING CENTER

| | |
|---|---|
| 5-4-783 | - Tent, General Purpose, Small; Cover |
| 5-4-961 | - Tent Sections, Frame Type, Expandable; Assembly |
| 5-4-962 | - Intermediate Section |
| 5-4-963 | - End Section |
| 5-4-964 | - End Section - Sections |
| 5-4-965 | - Window Details |



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| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 5-4-966 | - | Window Sections |
| 5-4-967 | - | Purlin and Heater Duct Details and Sections |
| 5-4-968 | - | Intermediate Vent Assembly |
| 5-4-969 | - | Intermediate Vent Sections |
| 5-4-970 | - | Stovepipe Opening Details and Sections |
| 5-4-971 | - | Becket Loop and Guy Line Lug Details, Sections and Enlarged Views |
| 5-4-972 | - | End Vent Assembly |
| 5-4-973 | - | End Vent Sections |
| 5-4-974 | - | Door Detail and Sections |
| 5-4-1043 | - | Carrying Cover, Arch |
| 5-4-1044 | - | Carrying Cover, Purlin |
| 5-4-1760 | - | Erection Instructions |

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

* 2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 2016 - Standard Test Methods for Moisture Content of Wood

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

* 2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.



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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.2, and 6.4).

3.2 Materials and components.

3.2.1 Cloth.

3.2.1.1 Sateen, wind-resistant. Cloth for the tent sections shall conform to MIL-C-12095, and the color shall be Olive Green 107.

3.2.1.2 Duck, cotton, 9.85 ounces. Cloth for the tent cover shall conform to MIL-C-43627, and the color shall be Olive Drab 7.

* 3.2.1.3 Duck, cotton, No. 6. Cloth for the frame carrying covers shall conform to type I, No. 6 hard texture of CCC-C-419, finished to conform to type I, class B, inhibitor (e) or as an alternate (d) of CCC-D-950, and the color shall be Olive Drab 7.

* 3.2.2 Tape, cotton. Tape shall conform to type I; class 4; 3/4, 1, 1 1/2, and 2 inch widths of MIL-T-43566, and the color shall be Olive Drab 7. For covers only, alternatively the tape shall be polypropylene conforming to type I, class 4, Olive Drab 7 of MIL-W-44049.

3.2.3 Webbing.

* 3.2.3.1 Webbing, cotton. Cotton webbing shall conform to type IIb, class 4, 1 inch width of MIL-W-530, and the color shall be Olive Drab 7. For covers only, alternatively the tape shall be polypropylene conforming to type IIb, class 4, Olive Drab 7 of MIL-W-44049.

* 3.2.3.2 Webbing, woven nylon. Nylon webbing shall conform to type VIII, class 1 or class 2 of MIL-W-4088, and the color shall be Olive Drab 7.

* 3.2.4 Thread, polyester. Thread shall conform to type I, class 1, subclass B, Olive Drab S-1 (CA 66022) of V-T-285. Dyed thread shall show colorfastness to weathering equal to or better than the standard shade sample (see 6.3). When no standard shade sample is available, the dyed thread shall show good colorfastness to weathering. Thread sizes shall be as follows:

a. For all stitching except zig-zag stitching and stitching indicated by "Z" on drawings size FF for needle and bobbin.



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b. For zig-zag stitching size E for needle and bobbin.

c. For stitching indicated by "Z" on drawing size FF for needle and size F for looper.

3.2.5 Fastener tape. Hook and pile synthetic tape shall conform to 2 inch width, type II hook, class 1, Olive Green 106 of MIL-F-21840.

* 3.2.6 Lines, tent. Tent lines shall conform to types I, XXI, and XXXV of MIL-L-1709, except that the type XXXV lines shall be finished in accordance with figure 3 of MIL-L-1709.

3.2.7 Stiffener, rope. Rope stiffeners for the window flaps and drip caps shall conform to type I or II, class 2, 1 inch circumference of MIL-R-1670.

* 3.2.8 Cord, polyester. Cord for the becket lines, vent lines, window flap lines, and toggle loops shall be 1/8 inch diameter, and the purlin lacing lines shall be 1/4 inch diameter, Olive Drab 7 conforming to MIL-C-43256.

3.2.9 Screening, nonmetallic. Screening shall conform to type III, class 1, size 18 by 18 of L-S-125 in the green color specified in L-S-125.

3.2.10 Film, plastic. Plastic film shall conform to the requirements for 0.0060 inch thick film, type I, class 1, grade A, B, or C, finish 1 of L-P-378 except that the film thickness shall be 0.020 ± 0.004 inch. The requirements for slip, ink adhesion, water vapor permeability, impact resistance, and heat seal strength shall not apply.

3.2.11 Shield, pipe. Stovepipe shields shall conform to MIL-S-43002.

3.2.12 Fasteners, snap. Snap fasteners shall conform to style 2, finish 2, button 24 line size, size 1 of MIL-F-10884.

* 3.2.13 Fasteners, slide, interlocking. The slide fastener shall conform to size H of V-F-106. The slide fastener chain shall be fabricated of brass or polyester coil. The slider for the brass chain shall be brass and the slider for the polyester coil shall be die cast zinc alloy. The length of the slide fastener chain shall be such that after the slide fastener is sewed on, the tape shall not be puckered and the slider shall operate freely. The slide fastener tape shall be dyed to match Olive Drab shade S (CA66519) and shall be water repellent and mildew-resistant treated. The color of the tape after treatment will be considered acceptable. The tape shall show good fastness to weathering. Alternatively, the slide fastener chain shall be polyester continuous monofilament in a ladder or coil type configuration. The color of the chain, slider, pull, and stops shall approximately match the tape color.



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As an alternate to using preassembled slide fasteners, a continuous chain application may be utilized as part of the manufacturing method. The method requires that the entire chain tape and tape extensions be securely stitched with the required seam without any puckering or waviness. The slider shall be indented into position to provide for a smooth running chain disengagement with the slider mouth squarely against the bottom staple stop and for a smooth running chain engagement with the slider throat evenly against the top stops and with no excess chain element showing. If continuous monofilament polyester chain is used, sewn top stops without gapping are allowed.

3.2.13.1 Flap, window. Window flap fasteners shall be type I, style 18, single wire stirrup pull.

3.2.13.2 Door. Door fasteners shall be type III, style 6, double wire stirrup pull.

* 3.2.14 Grommet, metallic. Grommets shall conform to type III, class 3, size Nos. 0, 1, 3, and 5 of MIL-G-16491.

3.2.15 Hooks, "S". "S" hooks shall conform to type XII, class 2, size G of MIL-H-639.

3.2.16 Slips, tent line. Tent line slips shall conform to type II of MIL-S-1734.

3.2.17 Loops, strap fastener. Strap loops shall conform to type III, style B of MIL-L-11075.

3.2.18 Clips, end. End clips shall conform to type I, class 1 or 2, 1 inch of MIL-C-496.

3.2.19 Adapter. Adapters for the carrying covers shall conform to the material, design, and dimensions specified on MS 70101.

3.2.20 Rings, connecting. Connecting rings shall conform to class 2 or 5, size 4 of MIL-R-2327.

3.2.21 Toggles, wood. Wood toggles shall be of the design and dimensions shown on Drawing 5-4-971. The toggles shall be fabricated from straight-grained, sound and smooth lumber and shall contain not more than 15 percent moisture when tested as specified in 4.4.1.1. The toggles shall be free from knots, shakes, checks, splits, splintery surfaces, or case hardening. Any of the following woods may be used:



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| | |
|---|---|
| Ash | Hickory |
| Beech | Maple, hard |
| Birch, yellow | Oak, red or white |
| Elm, rock | Pecan |

3.3 Construction. Construction shall conform to the drawings listed in section 2 and as specified herein.

3.3.1 Stitching, machine.

* 3.3.1.1 Types. All stitch types, except bartacking, shall conform to FED-STD-751 as follows:

a. For all stitching except zig-zag stitching and stitching indicated by "Z" on drawings and for attachment of slide fasteners - type 301, 5 to 7 stitches per inch.

b. For zig-zag stitching - type 304, 10 to 14 stitches per inch.

c. For stitching indicated by "Z" on drawings and for attachment of slide fasteners - type 401, 5 to 7 stitches per inch. Chain portion of stitching shall not appear on outside of tent or covers.

d. For bartacking - 5/8 ± 1/16 inch long, 1/8 inch minimum bight and containing 28 stitches.

3.3.1.2 Thread breaks. Thread breaks in stitching shall be overstitched not less than 1 inch at each break on stitch type 301, not less than 3/4 inch at each break on stitch type 304, and not less than 1 1/2 inches at each break on stitch type 401. Thread breaks in type 401 stitching may be overstitched with stitch type 301. Bartacks shall be free of thread breaks.

3.3.1.3 Stitching ends. The ends of 301 stitching shall be overstitched not less than 1 inch except where ends are turned under in a hem or held down by other stitching. Where 301 stitching is performed automatically on stitch patterns such as box, box with cross-stitch, "W" stitching, or straight line tacking, not less than three tying, overlapping, or back stitches shall be used to secure the ends of stitching. The ends of type 304 stitching shall be firmly secured by backstitching or overstitching or by increasing the number of stitches per inch at the ends for a minimum of 1/4 inch.

3.3.1.4 Skipped stitches. Two or more consecutively skipped stitches occurring in type 301 or 304 stitching shall be overstitched not less than 1 inch. Any skipped stitches in type 401 stitching shall be overstitched not less than 1 1/2 inches. Skipped stitches in 401 stitching may be overstitched with type 301 stitching.



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3.3.1.5 Thread lubricant. The addition of any lubricant to the polyester sewing thread prior to or during the sewing operation is prohibited.

3.3.2 Splicing of cloth. There shall be no splicing of tent end, intermediate sections, or cover panels. Splicing of reinforcements and sod cloth sections will be allowed provided no piece is less than 24 inches long. Pieces shall be joined as shown on Drawing 5-4-962.

* 3.3.3 Attachment of wood toggles. Attachment of wood toggles shall be as illustrated on drawings. Wrap cord around the toggle 1 1/2 times and secure with a overhand knot in a manner that prevents removal of toggle.

3.3.4 Attachment of slide fasteners. Care shall be exercised to trim all thread ends to 1/2 inch or less and to maintain specified distances between edges of fabric attached to slide fastener tape so that there will be no interference with the operation of the slider. The length of the slide fastener chain shall be such that after the slide fastener is sewed on, the tape shall not be puckered and the slider shall operate freely.

3.3.5 Setting of grommets. Holes punched to receive grommets shall be smaller than the outside diameter of the grommet barrel so that the barrel must be forced through the hole. Grommets shall be securely clinched without cutting the materials. Roll of the clinched grommet shall not contain more than three scores (splits).

3.3.6 Settings of end clips. Webbing shall be inserted the full depth of the clip. Clips shall be securely attached without cutting the webbing and the webbing shall lie flat at the point of entry.

3.3.7 Wicking of sewing thread (cup test). There shall be no dripping of water through the stitching when the tent section is tested as specified in 4.5.2. Seepage or leakage of water at a few points caused by hydrostatic pressure through needle holes or between plies of a lap seam shall not be scored as a failure. The seam leakage test is intended to insure that non-wicking thread has been utilized and that no lubrication has been added to the polyester thread prior to or during the sewing operation.

3.3.8 Repairs. All necessary repairs shall be effected in accordance with Department of the Army Field Manual FM 10-16, except that hand-sewn patches, or cemented patches other than as specified herein will not be acceptable. Cemented patches on holes, cuts, or tears not more than 1 inch in diameter or length, using cement specified in MIL-C-2399, will be permitted. A maximum of two cemented patches per section will be allowable without prior contracting officer authorization. All other repairs shall require authorization by the contracting officer. Repairs required as a result of failure of the cup test



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and when authorized by the contracting officer shall be performed by treating with a compound conforming to type I, class 2 of TT-P-595 prior to retesting (see 6.6).

3.4 Marking. All markings and labels shall conform to DDD-L-20.

3.4.1 Special marking. The letters "US" or the item nomenclature on the end sections, intermediate sections, frame carrying covers, and tent cover shall conform to type IV, class 9 in the size characters and locations shown on the drawings. Class 9 markings shall be clearly legible after subjection to accelerated weathering.

* 3.4.2 Identification labels. Identification labels shall conform to type VI, class 6 and shall be 3 1/2 inches by 5 1/2 inches minimum with a blank space of at least 1 1/4 inches provided on the bottom of the label for the Department of Defense Inspector's stamp. Identification labels shall be stitched to the end sections, intermediate sections, frame carrying covers, and tent cover in the locations shown on the drawings. Identification information may also be stenciled directly on the frame carrying covers and shall conform to type IV, class 6, 1/2 inch high in the locations shown on Drawings 5-4-1043 and 5-4-1044.

* 3.4.3 Erection instruction labels. Labels of erection instructions shall conform to type VI, class 7 and shall be stitched to the tent and tent cover in the locations shown on the drawings. The label shall be a proportionate copy of Drawing 5-4-1760 reproduced from a glossy print of the drawing furnished by the contracting officer. The size label shall be, borderline to borderline, 15 inches ± 1/4 inch in the long dimension, with a minimum of 1/2 inch margin outside of the borderline on all sides.

3.5 Workmanship. Cloth components shall be clean and free of holes, cuts, tears, or cloth defects such as multiple floats, broken or missing yarns, or areas untreated with compound. Webbing and tape shall not have frayed or scalloped edges and rope components shall be free of cuts or breaks. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching, and seam allowances shall be maintained with seams properly sewed so that no run-offs, twists, pleats, or open seams shall result. Care shall be taken in sewing to see that no needle chews occur. All thread ends shall be trimmed to 1/2 inch or less. Metal components shall be free of burrs, sharp edges, and corroded areas and shall not be broken or malformed.



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deformations. Any sample unit having one or more individual scale reading

## 4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this document shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirement in the document shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

* 4.1.2 Responsibility for dimensional requirements. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for assuring that all specified dimensions have been met. When dimensions cannot be examined on the end item, inspection shall be made at any point or at all points in the manufacturing process necessary to assure compliance with all dimensional requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.3 and 4.4.4 and tested as specified in 4.4.5. The presence of any defect or failure of any test shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.



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4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1.1 Testing of components. In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary documents and drawings, the test specified in 4.5.1 shall be performed on wood toggles specified in 3.2.22 for determination of moisture content. The lot shall be expressed in units of toggles. The sample unit shall be one wood toggle. There shall be one determination per sample unit and the result shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

4.4.2 In-process inspection. Inspection shall be made to determine that the following are as specified:

a. There shall be no lubrication of polyester thread prior to or during sewing operations for compliance with 3.3.1.5.

b. Holes punched to receive grommets are in compliance with 3.3.5.

Whenever nonconformance is noted, correction shall be made to the items affected and the process.

* 4.4.3 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in units of completely fabricated end sections, intermediate sections, tent covers, or frame carrying covers, as applicable. The sample unit shall be one end section, intermediate section, tent cover, or frame carrying cover, as applicable. The inspection level shall be I. For end sections, the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 15.0 for major defects, 40.0 for combined major and minor A defects, and 100.0 for total combined (major, minor A, and minor B) defects. For intermediate sections, the AQL shall be 10.0 for major defects, 25.0 for combined major and minor A defects,and 100.0 for total combined defects. For tent covers, the AQL shall be 2.5 for major defects, 10.0 for combined major and minor A defects, and 40.0 for total combined defects. For frame carrying covers, the AQL shall be 6.5 for major defects, 15.0 for combined major and minor A defects, and 65.0 for total combined defects.



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TABLE I. End item visual defects

| Examine | Defect | Classification | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Major | Minor A | Minor B |
| Cloth | Cut, tear, or hole (including exposed drill hole) greater than 1/8 inch in length or diameter: | | | |
| | - on tent section | X | | |
| | - on cover or sod cloth | | X | |
| | Cut, tear or hole (including exposed drill hole) 1/8 inch or less in length or diameter: | | | |
| | - more than 20 holes: | | | |
| | - on tent section | X | | |
| | - on cover or sod cloth | | X | |
| | - more than 10 but not more than 20 holes: | | | |
| | - on tent section | | X | |
| | - on cover or sod cloth | | | X |
| | - more than 5 but not more than 10 holes: | | | |
| | - on tent section | | | X |
| | Untreated area on either side of cloth more than 1 inch in length or diameter | | X | |
| | Broken or missing yarn; multiple floats clearly visible at normal inspection distance, approximately 3 feet | | X | |
| Screening | Cut or tear: | | | |
| | - more than 2 inches in length | X | | |
| | - 1/4 inch or less in length | | | X |
| | - more than 1/4 inch in length but not more than 2 inches in length | | X | |
| Webbing; tie tapes | Edge frayed or scalloped | | | X |
| | Cut or tear | | | X |
| | Tape omitted: | | | |
| | - one | | | X |
| | - two or more | | X | |



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TABLE I. End item visual defects - Continued

| Examine | Defect | Classification | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Major | Minor | |
| | | | A | B |
| Hardware | Broken | X | | |
| | Malformed: | | | |
| | - fails to perform intended function | X | | |
| | - but will perform intended function | | X | |
| | Corroded area | | | X |
| | Burr or sharp edge that may cause injury in handling or damage to fabric | X | | |
| | Not specified type or size | | X | |
| Grommets | Improperly set, two or more teeth exposed (except where a grommet is set as specified but is in an area of uneven thickness which prevents uniform clinching) | | | X |
| | Clinched loosely, allowing grommet to rotate around hole | | | X |
| | Clinched excessively tight (i.e., cutting cloth) | X | | |
| | Insecurely clinched (i.e., grommets or washers become disengaged) | X | | |
| | Set with barrel inserted from outside instead of inside: | | | |
| | - on eave or ridge | | X | |
| | - at any other location | | | X |
| | Roll of a grommet contains more than three scores (splits) | | | X |
| End clips | Improperly clinched (i.e., webbing not flat at point of entrance into clip) | | | X |
| | Clinched excessively tight, cutting webbing or loosely clinched (i.e., clip becomes disengaged from webbing) | | X | |



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documents, drawings, and publications. The following

TABLE I. End item visual defects - Continued

| Examine | Defect | Classification | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Major | Minor A | Minor B |
| Wood toggles | Contains knot, shakes, split, or splintery surface | | X | |
| Rope components, tent lines | Any cut or break: | | | |
| | - on ridge guy line | | X | |
| | - on eave guy line | | X | |
| | - on any other line | | | X |
| | Eye splice omitted | | X | |
| | Eye splice not as specified | | | X |
| | Free end not finished as specified | | | X |
| Cord | Not stitched as specified | X | | |
| Window opening | Not reinforced all around with 2-inch facing | | X | |
| Window pane | Any puncture, deep crease, or crack | X | | |
| | Pane not fully caught in facing stitching all around | | X | |
| Seams and stitching | Open seam on stitch type 301: | | | |
| | - for more than 1/4 inch but not more than 1 inch | | | X |
| | - for more than 1 inch | | X | |
| | Open seam on stitch type 401: | | | |
| | - one row of stitching open for 1 inch or less | | | X |
| | - one row of stitching open for more than 1 inch: | | | |
| | - on intermediate section | | X | |
| | - on end section or cover | | | X |
| | - both rows of stitching open (not necessarily at the same location): | | | |
| | - on intermediate section | X | | |
| | - on end section or cover | | X | |



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TABLE I. End item visual defects - Continued

| Examine | Defect | Classification | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Major | Minor A | Minor B |
| Seams and stitching - continued | | | | |
| | NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken, or when one or more skipped or run-off stitches occur. On double stitched seams, a seam shall be classified as open when either one or both sides of a seam are open. | | | |
| | Raw edges caught in stitching: | | | |
| | - more than 1 inch but not more than 3 inches | | | X |
| | - more than 3 inches | | X | |
| | Thread breaks: | | | |
| | - overstitched less than 1 1/2 inches on stitch type 401 | | | X |
| | - overstitched less than 1 inch on stitch type 301 | | | X |
| | - overstitched less than 3/4 inch on stitch type 304 | | | X |
| | NOTE: Thread breaks not overstitched shall be classified as open seams. | | | |
| | Needle chews resulting in cut, tear, or hole ( see cloth defects for cut, tear or hole) | | | |
| | Skipped stitches: | | | |
| | - overstitched less than 1 1/2 inches on stitch type 401 | | | X |
| | - overstitched less than 1 inch on stitch type 301 or 304 (when two or more skipped stitches occur consecutively) | | | X |



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TABLE I. End item visual defects - Continued

| Examine | Defect | Classification | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Major | Minor A | Minor B |
| Seams and stitching - continued | | | | |
| NOTE: | Skipped stitches not overstitched shall be classified as open seams. | | | |
| | One or more required rows of stitching omitted (except on boxstitching) | X | | |
| Boxstitching | Incomplete: | | | |
| | - one row of stitching omitted | | | X |
| | - two or more rows of stitching omitted | | X | |
| | Less than specified length by more than 1/8 inch | | | X |
| Bartacking | Less than specified length by more than 1/8 inch | | | X |
| | Width less than 1/8 inch | | X | |
| Stitching ends | Overstitched less than 1 inch on stitch type 301 (except where ends are held down by other stitching, turned under in a hem, or where stitching is performed automatically) | | X | |
| | Secured with less than three tying, over-lapping or back stitches when automatic stitching is performed | | | X |
| | Secured with less than 1/4 inch of backstitching, overstitching, or an increased number of stitches per inch at the end of stitch type 304 | | | X |
| Seams | Pleated: | | | |
| | - on tent section | | X | |
| | - on cover | | | X |



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TABLE I. End item visual defects - Continued

| Examine | Defect | Classification | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Major | Minor A | Minor B |
| Seams and stitching - continued | | | | |
| Seam type | Wrong seam type | X | | |
| Stitch type | Wrong stitch type | X | | |
| Stitch tension | Loose, resulting in an exposed bobbin or top thread, for more than 6 inches | | X | |
| | Tight, as evidenced by puckering on fabric, for more than 6 inches | | X | |
| Stitches per inch | Less than minimum specified (except on panel joining seams): | | | |
| | - one stitch | | | X |
| | - two or more stitches | | X | |
| | Less than minimum specified on panel joining seams | | X | |
| | More than maximum specified: | | | |
| | - one stitch | | | X |
| | - two or more stitches | | X | |
| | NOTE: Variation in the number of stitches per inch, caused by the operator speeding up the machine and pulling the fabric in order to sew over heavy places or heavy seams or in turning corners, shall be classified as follows:<br>a. With the minor "B" defect classification - no defect<br>b. Within the minor "A" defect classification - minor "B" defect | | | |
| Stitching gage | Not as specified | | X | |



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TABLE I. End item visual defects - Continued

| Examine | Defect | Classification | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Major | Minor A | Minor B |
| Seams and stitching - continued | | | | |
| Stitching margin | Larger than specified by more than 3/16 inch: | | | |
| | - for more than 2 inches but not more than 4 inches in length | | | X |
| | - for more than 4 inches in length | | X | |
| | Less than specified: | | | |
| | - for more than 2 inches but not more than 4 inches in length | | | X |
| | - for more than 4 inches in length | | X | |
| Stitching indicated by "Z" on drawings | Chain portion of stitching shows on outside of tent section or cover | X | | |
| Toggle stitching | Loose tension | X | | |
| | Not secured as specified, for example toggle can be removed | X | | |
| | Number of stitches | | | |
| | - more than specified | | | X |
| | - less than specified | X | | |
| Mends, darns, or patches | Repairs not in accordance with Department of the Army Field Manual FM 10-16 or not authorized by the contracting officer (see 3.3.8) | X | | |
| Components and assembly | Any component or part omitted, not assembled or fabricated of applicable referenced material | X | | |
| Hems | Constructed with partial turnunder when double turnunder is required | | X | |
| | Twisted or pleated | | | X |



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TABLE I. End item visual defects - Continued

| Examine | Defect | Classification | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Major | Minor A | Minor B |
| Components and assembly - continued | | | | |
| Reinforcements | Improperly applied, causing excessive fullness on reinforcement or reinforced parts | X | | |
| Cloth splicing | Splice in tent section or cover panel | X | | |
| | Spliced pieces not joined as shown on Drawing 5-4-962 | | | X |
| Slide fastener | Slider jams or fails to interlock chain | X | | |
| | Any tape improperly assembled, causing failure of chain to effect a smooth and secure closure | X | | |
| | Thong omitted | | | X |
| Stovepipe shield | Set to roof with oval opening in a horizontal instead of vertical position | X | | |
| | Exposed stitching or needle holes | | | X |
| General | Any other construction detail not performed as specified | | X | |
| Marking and labels | Omitted, incorrect, illegible, or misplaced | | | X |
| Cleanness | Grease or oil stains | | | X |
| | Thread ends not trimmed to 1/2 inch or less (except in slide fastener area) | | | X |
| | Thread ends not trimmed to 1/2 inch or less in slide fastener area | | X | |



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* 4.4.4 End item dimensional examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size shall be expressed in units of completely fabricated end sections, intermediate sections, tent covers, or frame carrying covers, as applicable. The sample unit shall be one end section, intermediate section, tent cover, or frame carrying cover, as applicable. The inspection level shall be S-3. For end sections or intermediate sections, the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects, 15.0 for combined major and minor A defects, and 65.0 for total combined (major, minor A, and minor B) defects. For tent covers or frame covers, the AQL shall be 2.5 for major defects, 10.0 for combined major and minor A defects, and 25.0 for total combined defects.

TABLE II. End item dimensional defects

| Examine | Defect | Classification | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Major | Minor A | Minor B |
| Overall dimensions of end sections; intermediate sections and frame carrying covers | Smaller than specified dimensions less applicable minus tolerances indicated on drawings | X | | |
| | Larger than specified dimensions and applicable plus tolerance indicated on drawings | | | X |
| Covers, tent | Smaller than specified dimensions less applicable minus tolerance indicated on drawing, but not smaller than the specified dimensions less twice the applicable minus tolerance | | | X |
| | Smaller than specified dimensions less twice the applicable minus tolerance indicated on drawing | | X | |
| | Larger than specified dimensions and applicable plus tolerance indicated on drawing | | | X |
| Location dimensions (unless otherwise specified) | Not within specified tolerance: - not exceeding twice the applicable tolerance | | | X |
| | - exceeding twice the applicable tolerance | | X | |



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TABLE II. End item dimensional defects - Continued

| Examine | Defect | Classification | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Major | Minor A | Minor B |
| Webbing, tie tapes | Finished length less than specified by more than 1 inch | | | X |
| Grommets | Set beyond specified location by more than 1/2 inch | | | X |
| Rope components; tent lines | Eye on footstop or line less than specified by more than 1/2 inch | | X | |
| | Finished length of guy line less than specified: | | | |
| | - by not more than 4 inches | | | X |
| | - by more than 4 inches but not more than 12 inches | | X | |
| | - by more than 12 inches | X | | |
| Beckets | Misplaced: | | | |
| | - by more than 1/4 inch but not more than 1/2 inch | | | X |
| | - by more than 1/2 inch | | X | |
| | Length of loop more or less than specified by 1/2 inch or more | | X | |
| Hems | Hems required to finish less than 3/4 inch in width, less than specified; hems required to finish more than 3/4 inch in width, less than specified by more than 1/4 inch | X | | |
| Reinforcements | Finished dimension less than specified by more than 1/2 inch | | | X |
| | Any spliced piece less than 24 inches in length | | | X |
| Sod cloths | Less than specified width by more than 1 inch | | | X |
| | Any spliced piece less than 24 inches in length | | | X |



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TABLE II. End item dimensional defects - Continued

| Examine | Defect | Classification | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Major | Minor A | Minor B |
| Window opening | Vertical center line out of alignment with center line of blanket: | | | |
| | - by more than 1/2 inch, but not more than 1 inch | | | X |
| | - by more than 1 inch | X | | |
| | Two inch facing uneven with edge of opening by more than 1/4 inch | | X | |
| Ventilator opening | Misplaced: - by more than 1/2 inch | | | X |
| Stovepipe opening | Misplaced: - by more than 1/2 inch | | | X |
| Tent cover flaps | Center line of flaps set off center of body by more than 3/4 inch | | | X |

4.4.5 End item testing. The completely fabricated tent section shall be tested as specified in 4.5.2 for compliance with 3.3.7. The lot shall be expressed in units of completely fabricated tent sections. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated end section or intermediate section, as applicable. The inspection level shall be S-3. Each sample unit shall be tested in two specified areas, and the results shall be reported as pass or fail. Failure in any area shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

* 4.4.6 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.



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| Examine | Defect |
|---|---|
| Marking (exterior and interior) | Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application |
| Materials | Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified |
| Workmanship | Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of cloth covered bundles or bundles insecurely sewn<br>Bulged or distorted container |

4.5 Methods of inspection.

* 4.5.1 Moisture content of wood toggles. The moisture content of wood toggles shall be determined in accordance with the oven-drying method referenced in ASTM D 2016.

4.5.2 Wicking of sewing thread (cup test). The tent sections shall be tested in two areas as follows: At a roof panel lap seam and on an eave purlin or header reinforcement seam.

* 4.5.2.1 Procedure. Suspend the seamed section of the test fabric in the center of a 6 ± 1/8 inch diameter hoop and form a depression with the seamed fabric in the hoop to a depth of 1 ± 1/4 inch. Slowly pour 500 mL of water at 77° ± 4°F into the cupped area (depression) and observe the under surface of the fabric for water penetration. Any wicking of water along the sewing thread, identified by a discoloration or darkening of the thread within 5 minutes after water is poured, shall constitute a failure. Water leakage through the needle holes or between the plies of the lapped seamed fabric shall not be considered a failure.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial, as specified.

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Tent (intermediate and end sections). Each tent intermediate section and each end section, with door and window slide fasteners closed, shall be folded to measure approximately 42 by 34 inches. All lines shall be



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placed within the folds. One folded tent intermediate section and two folded tent end sections shall be stacked together and placed within the cover provided. The cover shall be closed with the securing straps.

5.1.1.2 Components (when procured separately). (See 6.2)

5.1.1.2.1 Intermediate section. One tent intermediate section, folded as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be cross-tied with cord or twine.

5.1.1.2.2 End section. One tent end section, folded as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be cross-tied with cord or twine.

* 5.1.2 Commercial. Each complete tent or individual component or carrying cover shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing.

5.2.1.1 Tent (intermediate and end sections). One tent (an intermediate section and two end sections), preserved as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be packed in a close-fitting cleated plywood shipping container conforming to overseas type, style A of PPP-B-601. Each container shall be provided with skids fabricated as specified in PPP-B-601. Each container shall be closed and reinforced with flat steel strapping in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-601.

5.2.1.2 Components (when procured separately). (See 6.2.)

5.2.1.2.1 Intermediate sections and end sections. Five intermediate sections or ten end sections, preserved as specified in 5.1.1.2.1 or 5.1.1.2.2, respectively, shall be packed in a close-fitting shipping container conforming to overseas type, style A, type 3 load of PPP-B-601. Each container shall be provided with skids as specified in PPP-B-601. Each container shall be closed and reinforced with flat steel strapping in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-601.

5.2.2 Level B packing.

5.2.2.1 Tent (intermediate and end sections). One tent (an intermediate section and two end sections), preserved as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be wrapped in cotton Osnaburg cloth conforming to class 2 of CCC-C-429, or burlap cloth conforming to class 3 of CCC-C-467. The wrapping shall be securely hand-sewn with type I or II, 16-ply cotton twine conforming to T-T-871, or type I, size No. 2 jute twine conforming to T-T-911, with approximately one stitch to



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the inch and every third stitch overhand knotted. Alternatively, the seams of the wrap may be machine-sewn. In lieu of the sewn wrap, bias-sewn tubing conforming to MIL-T-40625 may be used. A minimum of 5 inches of wrapping material or tubing shall be gathered together on each of the four corners and securely sewn into ears for handles. Wherever machine sewing is used, the thread type, stitch type, and number of stitches per inch shall conform to the requirements specified in MIL-T-40625. The polyester thread used to manufacture the tent (an intermediate section and two end sections) may be used for effecting the machine-sewn closure of the wrapping or tubing.

5.2.2.2 Components (when procured separately). (See 6.2.)

5.2.2.2.1 Intermediate sections and end sections. Five intermediate sections or ten end sections, preserved as specified in 5.1.1.2.1 and 5.1.1.2.2, respectively, shall be packed in the same manner as 5.2.2.1.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Each complete tent or individual components, preserved as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

* 5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

5.3.1 Special marking. The shipment comprising a complete tent shall be set or assembly marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The tent sections are designed to be used in forming a 16 foot by 16 foot frame supported tent for use as a division tactical operations and planning center, communications center, and briefing tent. The tent is easily expandable in 16 foot increments.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. Type required (see 1.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1).
d. Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Components, when procured separately (see 5.1.1.2, 5.2.1.2, and 5.2.2.2).



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* 6.3 Standard sample. For access to samples, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids.

* 6.4 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition instruments regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

* 6.5 Components. The following components are required for the erection of the 16 foot by 16 foot tent:

| Component | Quantity | National Stock No. |
|---|---|---|
| Frame section, tent end section | 2 | 8340-00-234-4708 |
| Frame section, tent intermediate section | 1 | 8340-00-234-4712 |
| Pin, tent, aluminum, 9 inch | 18 | 8340-00-261-9749 |
| Pin, tent, steel, 12 inch | 6 | 8340-00-823-7451 |
| Pin, tent, wood 16 inch | 10 | 8340-00-261-9750 |

6.6 Repair. A satisfactory method of applying the compound for the repair of leaking seams is as follows:

a. A suitable volume of compound conforming to type I, class 1 of TT-P-595 (NSN 8030-00-290-4383) shall be thoroughly stirred and diluted with an equal volume of petroleum solvent (Stoddard solvent or equivalent). Thoroughly stir the mixture again before use.

b. Prior to application of the compound, the tent must be dry. Since the compound is flammable, special attention must be taken to ensure adequate ventilation and proper fire preventive measures are taken.

c. Two coats of the compound shall then be applied to the seams (on the outside of the tent section only). A 4-inch wide stiff brush is recommended for use. The first coat shall be air-dried for a minimum of 4 hours prior to application of the second coat. Elapsed time between coats may be reduced by providing a supply of hot air to evaporate the solvent more quickly. In this manner, a second coat may be applied as soon as the first



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coat is dry to the touch. After the application of the second coat, the treated tent section shall be allowed to air-dry for a period of at least 24 hours.

6.6.1 Seams to be treated. Seams that have failed the test specified in 4.5.2 should be treated as follows:

a. Failure of panel lap seam - treat all panel lap seams.

b. Failure at purlin or header reinforcement stitching - treat all stitching on reinforcements.

* 6.7 International standardization agreements. Certain provisions of this document are the subject of international standardization agreement as cited in NATO, STANAG NO. 2882, relative to camouflage requirements for tents, shelters, and subsidiary components. When amendment, revision, or cancellation of this document is proposed that will modify the international agreement concerned, the preparing activity will take appropriate action through international standardization channels including departmental standardization offices to change the agreement or make other appropriate accommodations.

* 6.8 Subject term (key word) listing.

Tent, expandable
Tent sections

6.9 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document have been marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only, and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content, as written, irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.



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Army - GL
Navy - NU
Air Force - 99

Review activities:

Army - MD
Air Force - 82
DLA - CT

User activities:

Navy - MC, YD
Air Force - 45

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8340-0503



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# STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

*(See Instructions – Reverse Side)*

| 1. DOCUMENT NUMBER | 2. DOCUMENT TITLE |
|---|---|
| MIL-T-43492C(GL) | Tent Sections, Frame Type, Expandable |

| 3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION | 4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)* |
|---|---|
| | ☐ VENDOR |
| b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* | ☐ USER |
| | ☐ MANUFACTURER |
| | ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____ |

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

| 7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional | 7b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional |
|---|---|
| 7c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional | 8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)* |

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

NATICK OP, 1 Apr 84

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